



Maldives
Polytechnic

Student Attendance Policy

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Section 1: Purpose

- 1.1. The purpose of this Student Attendance Policy at Maldives Polytechnic is to establish a consistent institutional standard for student attendance across all programs, ensuring alignment with the academic expectations of MQA-accredited programs and MNSDA-standard courses.
- 1.2. This policy promotes academic integrity, accountability, and responsibility among students while ensuring that learners meet the attendance benchmarks necessary for successful academic and skills-based outcomes.
- 1.3. The policy is designed to ensure that students engage regularly in learning activities, whether in face-to-face, blended, or Smart Campus (online) environments, and that students who face valid attendance challenges are supported through fair and transparent procedures.

Section 2: Scope of this Policy

- 2.1. This policy applies to all students enrolled at Maldives Polytechnic, including those pursuing programs accredited by the Maldives Qualifications Authority (MQA) and those registered in programs delivered under the Maldives National Skills Development Authority (MNSDA) framework.
- 2.2. The policy applies to all schools, centres, and campuses operating under Maldives Polytechnic, including online learning environments managed through the Polytechnic's Smart Campus.
- 2.3. It is relevant to academic staff, administrative staff, lecturers, campus coordinators, and student services officers involved in teaching, monitoring, recording, and verifying student attendance and managing related processes.



Section 3: Principles

- 3.1. Student attendance is a critical factor in the successful completion of learning outcomes and in ensuring quality and consistency in teaching and learning practices.
- 3.2. Attendance must be monitored consistently for all programs, regardless of mode of delivery, and be based on valid, reliable, and verifiable records.
- 3.3. A minimum attendance threshold is required for participation in final assessments, and no student should be exempted from meeting this requirement except under clearly defined conditions.
- 3.4. The institution shall provide support mechanisms to assist students who are unable to meet the required attendance due to medical conditions.
- 3.5. Instructors are responsible for clearly informing students of attendance expectations and for maintaining accurate and up-to-date attendance records.
- 3.6. Students are responsible for keeping track of their own attendance status and for promptly notifying the relevant authorities if they are unable to attend scheduled learning activities.

Section 4: Definitions

- 4.1. Attendance – Presence and participation in scheduled academic or training activities, including lectures, tutorials, online classes, and practical sessions.
- 4.2. MQA Programs – Academic and professional programs accredited by the Maldives Qualifications Authority that require module-based attendance tracking and minimum thresholds.



- 4.3. MNSDA Programs – Skills development and training programs aligned with the Maldives National Skills Development Authority that use cumulative attendance to determine exam eligibility.
- 4.4. Smart Campus – The online delivery platform of Maldives Polytechnic that supports synchronous and asynchronous learning activities.
- 4.5. Minimum Attendance – The institutional requirement that a student must maintain to be eligible for assessments and certification, normally set at 80%.
- 4.6. Valid Absence – A documented and accepted reason for missing a class or academic session, supported by medical certificates, legal notices, or employer/government letters.

Section 5: Attendance Guidelines

5.1. Attendance Requirements by Program Type

- 5.1.1. Students enrolled in MQA-approved programs must maintain a minimum of 80% attendance in each individual module. Attendance is calculated separately for each module.
- 5.1.2. Students enrolled in MNSDA-standard programs must maintain a minimum of 80% cumulative attendance across all units within the course. Individual unit attendance may vary, provided the overall attendance meets the threshold.
- 5.1.3. Students in either program category who fail to meet the 80% threshold will not be eligible for the final assessment, unless special approval is granted through the appeals process.
- 5.1.4. Students with attendance below 75% in any module (MQA) or overall program (MNSDA) are disqualified from all assessments and must repeat the module or course.



5.2. Smart Campus and Online Programs:

- 5.2.1. Attendance for Smart Campus learners will be based on login records, participation in live online classes, submission of tasks, and platform activity logs.
- 5.2.2. Smart Campus students are subject to the same attendance thresholds depending on whether their program is under MQA (per module) or MNSDA (cumulative).
- 5.2.3. Students must ensure access to functional devices and stable internet. Technical failures will not be accepted as valid excuses unless verified and reported according to procedure.

5.3. Lateness and Early Departure

- 5.3.1. Students who arrive more than fifteen (15) minutes late without a valid excuse will be marked absent for the entire session.
- 5.3.2. Students who leave a session early without prior approval will not be granted attendance for that session.
- 5.3.3. Chronic lateness or early departure may lead to official warnings and impact a student's academic standing.

5.4. Reporting Absences and Submitting Documentation

- 5.4.1. If a student is unable to attend a class due to illness, emergency, or official obligation, they must notify the relevant lecturer or student support section as soon as possible.
- 5.4.2. Documentation supporting the absence must be submitted within three (3) working days of returning. Valid documents include:
 - (a) Medical certificates issued by licensed clinics or hospitals.
 - (b) Official letters from employers, government agencies, or courts.
 - (c) Evidence of emergencies, such as police reports or travel delays.



- 5.4.3. In the case of prolonged illness or emergency, a student's parent, spouse, or guardian may notify the Polytechnic and submit documents on the student's behalf.

5.5. Attendance Records and Monitoring

- 5.5.1. Lecturers must record attendance daily and submit records through the approved attendance tracking system.
- 5.5.2. Campus Coordinators and Course Coordinators must regularly review attendance reports and notify at-risk students.
- 5.5.3. Students have the right to review their attendance records and must immediately report discrepancies to the lecturer or campus office.

5.6. Exam Eligibility and Attendance:

- 5.6.1. Students with at least 80% attendance (per module or overall) are eligible to sit for the final exam.
- 5.6.2. Students with 75%–79% attendance may apply for special consideration through the Student Appeals supported by documentation.
- 5.6.3. Students with below 75% attendance will be automatically disqualified from final exams and must repeat the module or course.
- 5.6.4. If a student misses an exam due to illness or emergency, they must notify the lecturer or administration before the end of the exam and submit a valid medical certificate within twenty-four (24) hours.
- 5.6.5. Upon approval, the student may be offered a supplementary exam or alternate assessment.

5.7. Appeals and Complaints:

- 5.7.1. Students may appeal attendance decisions or exam ineligibility by submitting a written appeal within three (3) official working days of notification.



5.7.2. Appeals must be submitted using the designated form available at Student Service or the institutional website.

5.7.3. Appeals will be reviewed by the Student Affairs Section, and decisions forwarded to the Academic Board if required.

5.8. Record Keeping and Quality Assurance:

5.8.1. Attendance records must be retained by the Student Affairs Section for at least one academic year after course completion.

5.8.2. Attendance data must be auditable and available to internal and external quality assurance reviewers.

5.8.3. The Student Affairs section will oversee compliance with this policy and ensure accurate reporting at the institutional level.

Section 6: Review and Update

6.1. This Student Attendance Policy shall be reviewed every five academic years or earlier as needed, based on changes in national regulations, academic policy, or institutional priorities.

6.2. The Academic Section shall coordinate the review process in collaboration with Student Support Section, campus heads, lecturers, quality assurance officers, and representatives from the MQA and MNSDA if required.

6.3. All amendments must be submitted to the Academic Board for approval. Once approved, updates shall be communicated to students and staff and published on the Polytechnic website and learning platform.

